

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 10 8 4  
 ♥ Q J 9  
 ♦ K 9 5 2  
 ♣ 9 3

♠ K 9 3

♥ A 7 6 5 4

♦ J 8

♣ Q 7 4



♠ J 7 6 5 2

♥ 3

♦ 10 6 4

♣ A K 10 5

♠ A

♥ K 10 8 2

♦ A Q 7 3

♣ J 8 6 2

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              |       |      | 1 ♦   |
| Pass         | 1 ♥   | Pass | 2 ♥   |
| Pass         | 4 ♥   |      |       |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 4 ♥ by North |       |      |       |

[showcards W:CA N:C2]

You are West. The bidding has been as shown.

Partner led the ♣A, dummy played the ♣2

Play the ♣3.

If you signal with the ♣9 East will continue with the ♣K and another which you will have to ruff. You will give up your NATURAL trump trick by doing so. Worse, you will allow South's ♣J to be established as a winner that North can later discard a ♦ on.

Much better to play low. Partner will surely switch to a ♦, and North will probably finesse, though it doesn't matter whether he does or not. You will win the ♦K, return the ♣9 back to East's ♣K, and still have your trump trick for later.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K Q 10 7

♥ 10 9

♦ 9 7 2

♣ K 8 4

♠ J 6 4 2

♥ J 6 3

♦ A J 6

♣ 10 7 3



♠ 9 3

♥ 5 4

♦ Q 10 8 3

♣ J 9 6 5 2

♠ 8 5

♥ A K Q 8 7 2

♦ K 5 4

♣ A Q

West

North

East

South

1 ♠

2 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by South

♠ J if you hadn't played this way.

You are West. The bidding has been as shown. You led the ♠ A, East plays the ♠ 9, South the ♠ 5. You assume East has signaled you to continue ♠ s, so you play the ♠ Q. On this trick East plays the ♠ 3 and South the ♠ 8. How will you continue?

You know that both East and South are now void of ♠ s. You might just switch suits, but you have a better choice.

If you play your ♠ Q, East won't bother ruffing, South **WILL** ruff and dummy's ♠ J will be established as a winner.

The best procedure is to lead a low ♠ . East will ruff and South will over-ruff but by playing this way you stop the establishment of North's ♠ J. As you can see, South would have been able to discard a loser on that